SECURE BROWSING PRACTICES

Employee Secure Browsing Checklist

Task	Task 29
Domain	Cybersecurity
Objective	Develop safe Internet usage practices for employees
Tools	Web browser and Google Docs
Deliverable	Secure browsing checklist

Prepared as a practical awareness resource for employees. Use this checklist before browsing, downloading files, entering credentials, or installing browser add-ons.

Prepared by: _____

Date: _____

1. Introduction

Web browsers are used every day to access email, company portals, cloud documents, and other online services. Unsafe browsing can expose employees and organizations to phishing, malware, credential theft, and data leakage. This checklist describes simple habits that reduce these risks.

2. Secure Browsing Checklist

- **Check the website address:** Read the domain carefully. Watch for misspellings, extra words, unusual subdomains, and misleading characters.
- **Look for HTTPS:** Before entering passwords or sensitive information, confirm the address begins with https:// and the browser does not show a certificate or security warning. HTTPS encrypts data in transit, but it does not prove a website is trustworthy.
- **Avoid suspicious links:** Do not open unexpected links in emails, texts, pop-ups, or social media messages. Visit important sites by typing the known address or using a trusted bookmark.
- **Download carefully:** Download files only from trusted official websites or approved company sources. Avoid unexpected attachments and executable files. Scan downloads with approved security software.
- **Keep the browser updated:** Enable automatic updates where possible. Install browser and operating-system security updates promptly.
- **Review browser extensions:** Install only necessary extensions from trusted sources. Check permissions, developer details, reviews, and update history. Remove extensions you do not recognize or use.
- **Block suspicious pop-ups:** Use the browser's pop-up and redirect controls. Never trust pop-ups claiming your device is infected or asking you to call a number or install software.
- **Protect passwords and accounts:** Use unique passwords and a trusted password manager. Enable multi-factor authentication where available. Never enter credentials after following an unexpected link.
- **Use safe networks:** Avoid accessing sensitive company systems over public Wi-Fi unless using the organization's approved secure connection or VPN.
- **Protect confidential data:** Do not upload company files to unapproved websites or online tools. Sign out on shared devices and avoid saving passwords on public computers.
- **Report suspicious activity:** If you open a suspicious link, download an unexpected file, or enter credentials on a questionable site, contact the IT/security team promptly and follow incident-reporting procedures.

3. Quick Checks Before Entering Information

Question	Safe practice
Is this the correct website?	Verify the complete domain and spelling.
Is the connection protected?	Look for HTTPS and no browser security warning.
Was the link expected?	If unexpected, verify with the sender through another channel.
Does the site need this information?	Share only the minimum required information.
Is this device/browser up to date?	Apply updates and remove unneeded extensions.

4. Interview Questions

Q1. Why should we check HTTPS?
HTTPS encrypts information sent between the browser and website, helping protect it from being read or changed in transit. However, HTTPS alone does not guarantee that a website is legitimate, so the domain must also be checked.

Q2. Why should browser extensions be reviewed?
Extensions may request access to browsing history, website content, or other data. A malicious, compromised, or unnecessary extension can create privacy and security risks. Review permissions and remove extensions that are not needed or trusted.

5. Recommended Employee Habits

• Use company-approved browsers and security tools.

• Do not bypass browser certificate warnings.

• Verify unusual requests with the person or organization using a separate trusted channel.

• Keep work and personal accounts separate where required by company policy.

• Report incidents quickly rather than hiding mistakes.

6. Conclusion

Secure browsing depends on careful decisions and consistent habits. Checking website addresses, using HTTPS appropriately, downloading only trusted files, updating browsers, reviewing extensions, and reporting suspicious activity help reduce common online risks. Employees should follow their organization's security policies and ask the IT/security team when uncertain.

End of Report